

8.7

Competitive advantage

Worksheet

Why should customers choose your company rather than your competitors? Decide which of the following areas are relevant to your business and make a few notes. Add an idea of your own at the end. Then discuss your ideas.

- **Physical space.** Front office; Reception area; Sales area
- **Public relations.** Employee attitude and helpfulness; Employee appearance
- **Initial procedures.** Filling in forms; Establishing needs; Advice; Follow-up
- **Ordering.** Acknowledgment of order; Procedure if agreed conditions have to be changed
- **Information.** Detailed product information; Clear instructions for use; Clear invoicing
- **Product quality.** Composition/Ingredients; Active life; Running costs; Environmentally friendly
- **Customization.** Ability to customize your products to the customer's specific requirements
- **Packaging and design.** Styling; Design; Size; Colour; R&D (research and development) input
- **Additional services.** Guarantees; Service contracts; Training in how to use and maintain the product
- **Customer Service.** After-sales access; Telephone help; Maintenance and servicing
- **Financial.** Payment; Flexibility of terms
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